

argued that loyal young Americans had been used to commit terrible acts of violence in the name of freedom, against a people who posed no threat to the US.

On the other side were the so-called hard-hat demonstrators. On May 8, 1971, 200 construction workers assaulted antiwar protesters in New York City. Chanting "America, love it or leave it," these counter-protesters beat some peace marchers with work tools. On May 20, at least 100,000 paraded in New York City in support of Nixon's administration.